

Creamy Spaghetti with Brussels Sprouts

This Brussels sprouts spaghetti is comfort food at its finest. The pasta simmers directly in broth for a starchy, full-bodied base that gets coated in a creamy Asiago sauce with a subtle kick of red pepper. Brussels sprouts and shallots add caramelized sweetness and earthy depth, while fresh basil brightens the final dish. It's a one-pan dinner that's perfect for a weeknight meal when the cozy vibes are calling.

By **Amanda Stanfield** | Published on November 20, 2025

 Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 40 mins

Total Time: 40 mins

Servings: 4

Nutrition Profile:

No Added Sugar Gut Healthy Mediterranean Diet Sesame-Free High-Calcium Bone Health Weight Loss Nut-Free Healthy Pregnancy Healthy Aging Healthy Immunity Soy-Free Vegetarian High-Protein Egg-Free Low-Calorie

Ingredients

- 3 teaspoons extra-virgin olive oil, divided
- 2 large shallots, chopped (about ½ cup)
- 8 ounces Brussels sprouts, trimmed and halved (about 2 cups)
- 2 tablespoons water plus 1½ cups, divided, plus more as needed
- 3 medium cloves garlic, finely chopped (1 tablespoon)
- 8 ounces whole-wheat spaghetti
- 2½ cups unsalted vegetable broth
- 1⅓ cups finely grated Asiago cheese (about 2½ ounces), plus more for garnish
- ¾ cup heavy cream
- ⅛ teaspoon crushed red pepper, plus more for garnish
- ⅛ teaspoon salt
- 2 tablespoons thinly sliced fresh basil

Directions

Step 1

Heat 2 teaspoons oil in a large skillet over medium heat. Add chopped shallots; cook, stirring often, until fragrant, about 1 minute. Add halved Brussels sprouts and 2 tablespoons water. Cover and cook, stirring

occasionally and adding 1 tablespoon water at a time as needed to prevent burning, until bright green and tender, 5 to 8 minutes. Stir in chopped garlic and the remaining 1 teaspoon oil. Cook, uncovered and stirring constantly, until fragrant, about 30 seconds. Transfer the mixture to a medium heatproof bowl. Wipe the skillet clean.

Step 2

Combine 8 ounces pasta, 2½ cups broth and the remaining 1½ cups water in the skillet. Cover and bring to a boil over high heat. Boil, covered, stirring occasionally, until the pasta is al dente and the liquid is nearly absorbed, about 12 minutes.

Step 3

Stir in 1⅔ cups Asiago, ¾ cup cream, ½ teaspoon crushed red pepper and ½ teaspoon salt. Cook, stirring constantly, until the sauce thickens, 2 to 4 minutes. Remove from heat and return the Brussels sprouts mixture to the skillet. Using tongs, toss to coat evenly. Sprinkle with 2 tablespoons basil. Garnish with additional crushed red pepper and/or Asiago, if desired.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I have to cook the pasta in vegetable broth?

You can cook it in water, but we found that the vegetable broth makes a difference in enhancing the flavor as the pasta absorbs the liquid.

How can I prevent my Brussels sprouts from becoming soggy?

Soggy sprouts usually result from overcrowding the pan with them. However, for this recipe, you won't need to worry about that, as a large skillet can handle the amount you will be cooking.

How should I store and reheat leftovers?

Store leftovers in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 4 days. When you're ready to reheat, use the microwave in 1- to 2-minute increments until the food reaches the desired temperature. Alternatively, you can reheat it in a skillet over medium heat.

Can I freeze the leftovers?

We don't recommend freezing because the cream can separate and become grainy, and that can make it unappetizing.

What should I serve with Creamy Spaghetti with Brussels Sprouts?

We would serve the pasta alongside fresh greens featured in one of our favorite salads, such as the Leafy Green Salad, Basic Green Salad with Vinaigrette or Simple Green Salad with Citronette. Pairing the pasta with a protein like slices of roasted chicken breast, turkey or pork, would enhance the meal. For convenience, opt for a store-bought rotisserie chicken or consider making our Crispy Baked Chicken Cutlets, Air-Fryer Turkey Breast or Air-Fryer Pork Tenderloin.

EatingWell.com, November 2025

Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size about 1½ cups** 443 calories; total fat 26g; saturated fat 14g; cholesterol 62mg; sodium 442mg; total carbohydrate 41g; dietary fiber 6g; total sugars 6g; added sugars 0g; protein 16g; vitamin c 53mg; calcium 308mg; iron 3mg; potassium 528mg

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers, M.S. and Linda Frahm

*Additional reporting by **Carrie Myers, M.S. and Linda Frahm***

Explore more:

Ingredient

Pasta and Noodle

Pasta by Shape

Spaghetti

Was this page helpful?



